When should it switch?

IoT · Level 3 · Lesson 2



Today you will

- Choose a threshold for a rule from real readings.
- Explain false alarms and misses, and decide which costs more.
- Use two thresholds so a device doesn't flick on and off.

Choosing the number

- Choose from real readings
- False alarm or miss: which costs more?
- Too many false alarms: nobody listens
- Two thresholds stop the flicker

Find the two thresholds

1. Choose a device that switches itself: a fridge or a heater.
2. Make a table: time on, time off.
3. Listen for an hour and fill in the table.
4. Work out how long it runs and how long it rests.
5. Decide: one threshold, or two?

Don't open any device, touch wiring or hot parts, or unplug anything: just listen and watch. Ask before you go into someone else's room.

Let’s discuss

1. Which alarm in your life cries wolf, and what number would you change?
2. When is a miss worse than a false alarm?
3. Why does a fridge run for minutes, not seconds?

Check yourself

- Give one alarm where a miss costs more, and one where a false alarm costs more.